

ChurnGuard — Step 5: Alternatives Hub + Comparison Pages (Copy Deck v1)

Date: 2026-08-22 **Scope:** /alternatives hub page + first 3 comparison pages: /alternatives/churnzero, /alternatives/gainsight, /alternatives/churnkey **Batch 2 (later):** /alternatives/totango, /alternatives/baremetrics, /alternatives/planhat, /alternatives/vitally, /alternatives/custify

Honesty rules for every comparison page (non-negotiable)

1. **Be fair to competitors.** They are good products — for the companies they were built for. Our wedge is segment, not superiority: “built for CS teams” vs “built for teams without one.”
2. **Every competitor fact gets a date stamp.** Pricing/platform claims stated as “as of August 2026” and hedged when unverified (“reported”, “not publicly listed”).
3. **No invented ratings, review counts, or customer numbers** — for them OR for us.
4. **Every page carries a visible “Last updated” date** (winning SERP pattern + freshness signal).
5. **No fake head-to-head feature checkmarks** we can’t back. Compare segments and models, not fabricated feature matrices.
6. ChurnGuard’s own claims follow the codebase-verified list: retention emails, dunning (3-step), win-backs, risk scoring (30-day trailing window), usage signals via widget, 30-day trial, cancel anytime, published pricing (\$79/\$149/\$299).

PAGE 0 — /alternatives (the hub)

Metadata:

- Title: Customer Success & Churn Tool Alternatives — Honest Comparisons | ChurnGuard
- Description: Comparing churn prevention and customer success tools? Honest, dated comparisons of ChurnZero, Gainsight, Churnkey and more — written for small SaaS teams without a CS department.
- Canonical: /alternatives

H1: Customer success tool alternatives — compared honestly

Intro:

Most “alternatives” pages are written to trash the competition. These aren’t. Every tool listed here is good at what it was built for — the question is whether it was built for *you*. If you run a CS department at a mid-market or enterprise company, the big suites will serve you well. If you’re a founder-led SaaS team doing support, sales, and product at once, you need something else. That’s the lens for every comparison below. We date our facts, link our sources, and tell you when the other tool is the better choice.

Section — The comparisons (cards linking to each page):

1. **ChurnGuard vs ChurnZero** — The category’s leading CS platform vs automated playbooks for small teams. *When the honest answer is ChurnZero — and when it’s us.* → /alternatives/churnzero
2. **ChurnGuard vs Gainsight** — The company that invented customer success software vs the tool for companies that can’t hire CS yet. → /alternatives/gainsight

3. **ChurnGuard vs Churnkey** — Cancel-flow and dunning specialist vs full pre-cancellation automation. → /alternatives/churnkey

Section — How to choose (3 questions):

- 1. **Do you have (or plan to hire) a customer success team?** If yes, evaluate the CS platforms — they’re built for that. If no, a platform that needs a CS team to run it becomes shelfware.
- 2. **Do you want analytics or actions?** Dashboards tell you who is leaving. Playbooks do something about it — automatically.
- 3. **What’s your real budget?** Enterprise CS suites are custom-quoted and typically priced for companies with dedicated CS headcount. Self-serve tools publish prices you can check today.

Closing CTA: Not sure where you stand? Run the free churn audit — your own numbers will tell you what you need. → /audit

PAGE 1 — /alternatives/churnzero

Metadata:

- Title: ChurnZero Alternative for Small SaaS Teams — ChurnGuard
- Description: ChurnZero is built for customer success teams. ChurnGuard is built for SaaS teams that don't have one. An honest comparison — pricing, setup, and who each tool is really for. Updated August 2026.
- Canonical: /alternatives/churnzero

H1: The ChurnZero alternative for teams without a CS department

Intro (fair framing):

ChurnZero is one of the leading customer success platforms — an AI-driven system for CS teams, with health scores, “Plays,” journey orchestration, and in-app messaging. If you have customer success managers, it’s genuinely one of the strongest options on the market.

But ChurnZero is sold to CS teams, priced by custom quote, and run by CS professionals. If you’re a founder-led SaaS where the “retention department” is also the person answering support tickets, the question isn’t whether ChurnZero is good. It’s whether a platform built for a CS team makes sense for a team of five.

Comparison table (all competitor facts “as of August 2026”):

	ChurnZero	ChurnGuard
Built for	Companies with customer success teams	Founder-led SaaS, no CS hire
Pricing	Custom quote only —not publicly listed	Published: \$79 / \$149 / \$299 per month by MRR band
Free trial	Demo-led sales process	30-day free trial, no card required
Setup	Onboarding with their team; weeks is typical for CS platforms	Connect Stripe in minutes; optional one-line snippet for usage signals

Table 1 – continued

	ChurnZero	ChurnGuard
What it does	Health scores, journeys, Plays, in-app messaging —run by your CSMs	Detects churn risk from billing + usage signals, then automatically sends retention emails, dunning, and win-backs
Who operates it	A CS manager	Nobody —playbooks run automatically once toggled on
Contract	Annual contracts typical for the category	Monthly, cancel anytime

Choose ChurnZero if: you have (or are hiring) customer success managers, you manage complex enterprise accounts with high-touch relationships, and you need journey orchestration across a large book of business.

Choose ChurnGuard if: you're a small SaaS team where nobody's job title is "customer success," you want churn handled automatically rather than dashboards someone has to check, and you want to know the price before you talk to anyone.

Honest box (styled as a callout):

To be direct: if you have a three-person CS team, ChurnZero is probably the better tool and we'd tell you to take their demo. ChurnGuard exists for the thousands of SaaS companies that will never make that hire.

FAQ (with FAQPage schema):

- Q: Is ChurnZero pricing public?** A: No — as of August 2026, ChurnZero sells by custom quote through a demo-led process. Industry estimates for CS platforms in its class typically start in the tens of thousands per year. ChurnGuard publishes its prices: \$79–\$299/month depending on your MRR.
- Q: Can ChurnGuard replace ChurnZero?** A: For a small team, yes — you don't need journey orchestration if nobody has time to build journeys. For a company with a CS organization, no — ChurnZero offers depth (in-app messaging, enterprise integrations, CSM workflows) that ChurnGuard doesn't try to match.
- Q: What does ChurnGuard actually do when a customer is at risk?** A: It acts, without you: risk signals from your Stripe billing (and product usage, if you install our one-line snippet) trigger retention email sequences, failed-payment recovery, and win-back campaigns automatically. You see the results in dollars recovered.

CTA: See what ChurnGuard would catch in your Stripe account — free audit, no card. → /audit

Last updated: August 2026

PAGE 2 — /alternatives/gainsight

Metadata:

- Title: Gainsight Alternative for Startups & Small SaaS — ChurnGuard

- Description: Gainsight invented customer success software — for enterprises. ChurnGuard is automated churn prevention for small SaaS teams. An honest, dated comparison. Updated August 2026.
- Canonical: /alternatives/gainsight

H1: The Gainsight alternative for companies that can’t hire customer success

Intro:

Gainsight created the customer success software category. It’s the enterprise standard — powerful, deep, and trusted by some of the biggest names in software. If you’re running a CS organization at scale, Gainsight is the safe, proven choice.

It’s also built for a world where you have CS ops, a data team, and an implementation budget. Gainsight doesn’t publish pricing, sells through enterprise contracts, and is typically implemented over months with professional services. None of that is a criticism — it’s what enterprises need. It’s just not what a 5-person SaaS needs.

Comparison table (competitor facts as of August 2026):

	Gainsight	ChurnGuard
Built for	Enterprise CS organizations	Founder-led SaaS, no CS hire
Pricing	Not public; enterprise contracts (reported to start in the tens of thousands per year)	Published: \$79 / \$149 / \$299 per month
Free trial	No —demo and sales process	30-day free trial, no card required
Time to value	Implementation measured in weeks to months	Connect Stripe, toggle playbooks —same day
What it does	Full CS platform: health scores, timelines, playbooks, community, product experience suite	Automated churn prevention: risk detection + retention emails, dunning, win-backs that fire without you
Who operates it	CS ops / CSMs	Runs itself

Choose Gainsight if: you have a CS org (or budget to build one), enterprise accounts requiring high-touch management, and the implementation runway for a platform rollout.

Choose ChurnGuard if: you need churn handled this week, not this quarter — and the person who would “own the CS platform” is already doing three other jobs.

Honest box:

Gainsight’s customers include some of the best-run software companies in the world. If you become one of those companies, buy Gainsight. ChurnGuard is for getting there without losing the customers you have now.

FAQ (with FAQPage schema):

1. **Q: How much does Gainsight cost?** A: Gainsight doesn’t publish pricing as of August 2026; it’s quoted per company through an enterprise sales process, and third-party reports typically put entry points in the tens of thousands per year. ChurnGuard’s pricing is public: from \$79/month.

2. **Q: Is ChurnGuard a “lite Gainsight”?** A: No — different philosophy. Gainsight gives CS professionals tools to work with. ChurnGuard removes the work: playbooks detect risk and send retention emails, dunning, and win-backs automatically. One is a platform you operate; the other is automation you switch on.
3. **Q: Can I start with ChurnGuard and move to Gainsight later?** A: Yes — that’s a path we encourage. Use ChurnGuard while you’re small; if you eventually build a CS organization, you’ll graduate to enterprise tooling with clean retention data behind you.

CTA: Run the free churn audit and see your at-risk revenue in minutes. → /audit

Last updated: August 2026

PAGE 3 — /alternatives/churnkey

Metadata:

- Title: Churnkey Alternative — Churn Prevention Before the Cancel Button | ChurnGuard
- Description: Churnkey is excellent at the cancellation moment. ChurnGuard works earlier — catching churn risk weeks of silence before the cancel click. Honest comparison, updated August 2026.
- Canonical: /alternatives/churnkey

H1: The Churnkey alternative that acts before the cancel page

Intro:

Churnkey is one of the best tools in this space at what it focuses on: the cancellation moment. Its cancel flows — exit surveys, save offers, pause options — plus dunning and win-back campaigns are polished, quantified, and well-reviewed. If your churn happens at the cancel button, Churnkey catches it beautifully.

The question is timing. By the time a customer reaches your cancel page, most of the decision was made weeks earlier — in silence: logins fading, onboarding stalled, usage dropping. Churnkey’s center of gravity is the moment of cancellation. ChurnGuard’s is everything that happens before it.

Comparison table (competitor facts as of August 2026):

	Churnkey	ChurnGuard
Core focus	The cancel moment: cancel flows, exit surveys, save offers	The weeks before it: risk detection from billing + usage signals, automatic retention outreach
Also covers	Dunning, win-back campaigns	Dunning (3-step sequence), win-backs —plus onboarding rescue and silent-churn re-engagement
Pricing	Published; plans start around \$250/month	Published: \$79 / \$149 / \$299 per month
Free entry	Free churn metrics tool	30-day free trial + permanently free churn audit

Table 3 – continued

	Churnkey	ChurnGuard
Setup	Install cancel flow + connect billing	Connect Stripe in minutes; optional one-line snippet for usage signals
Best for	SaaS with meaningful cancel-page traffic	Small teams wanting the whole pre-cancel window covered automatically

Choose Churnkey if: your biggest leak is at the cancel button itself and you want best-in-class cancel flows with offer testing and exit surveys.

Choose ChurnGuard if: you want to catch customers while they’re quietly drifting — before they ever see a cancel page — and you want dunning and win-backs included at a lower entry price.

Honest box:

These two tools overlap less than you’d think. Some teams use a cancel-flow tool and an early-warning tool together. If budget forces one choice, ask where your churn actually happens — our free audit will show you.

FAQ (with FAQPage schema):

- Q: Does ChurnGuard have cancel flows like Churnkey?** A: No — and we won’t pretend otherwise. ChurnGuard covers everything before the cancel click: usage-fade detection, onboarding rescue, failed-payment recovery, and post-cancellation win-back emails. If cancel-flow optimization is your top need, Churnkey is genuinely strong there.
- Q: Which is cheaper?** A: ChurnGuard. As of August 2026, Churnkey’s published plans start around \$250/month; ChurnGuard starts at \$79/month with a 30-day free trial, no card required.
- Q: Can I use both?** A: Yes — they address different moments. ChurnGuard catches risk early and acts automatically; a cancel-flow tool optimizes the final decision screen. There’s no technical conflict between them.

CTA: Find out where your churn actually happens — free Stripe audit, results in minutes. → /audit

Last updated: August 2026

Technical notes for the build (for the Claude Code prompt)

- New routes: `app/alternatives/page.tsx` (hub) + `app/alternatives/[competitor]/page.tsx` OR three static route folders — Claude Code’s choice, but EACH page must have its own metadata (title/description/canonical as specified above) via the `layout.tsx` pattern already established in this codebase (pricing/audit pages are the reference).
- Each comparison page includes its own `FAQPage` JSON-LD with exactly the Q&As above as `mainEntity`.
- Hub page links to the 3 pages; add an “Alternatives” link to the footer(s) (PublicShell + DarkShell) next to the existing links.

- Match the existing design system (the site uses slate/dark theme tokens, e.g. DK_TEXT/DK_MUTED/DK_BORDER or equivalent).
- “Last updated: August 2026” visible at the bottom of each comparison page.
- All internal CTAs link to /audit.
- Tables must render readably on mobile (stacked or scrollable).
- After build: add the 4 new URLs to the sitemap if the sitemap is manually maintained; if it’s dynamic (app/sitemap.ts), add the new routes there.